American International School in Abu Dhabi

AISA STAFF GUIDE

# Student Data Anonymizer

## A Guide for Teachers and Staff

Use AI to analyze student data without the AI ever seeing who your students are.

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OPEN THE TOOL

**aisa-ai-web.github.io/data-anonymizer**

No sign-in needed. Works in an up-to-date Chrome, Edge or Safari on a school laptop.

YOUR DATA STAYS WITH YOU

The tool runs entirely in your browser. Your files are never uploaded anywhere.

# What is the Student Data Anonymizer?

It's a web tool that prepares a student spreadsheet so you can ask an AI tool to analyze it, for example to find learning gaps or plan support groups, without the AI seeing who the students are. It swaps names and ID numbers for codes like **STU-004** and removes details the AI doesn't need. When the AI answers, the tool turns the codes back into your students' names.

## How it works

**1**

### Anonymize

Upload your spreadsheet. Names and IDs become codes; private details are removed.

**2**

### Keep the key

Save a private key file that records which code belongs to which student.

**3**

### Ask the AI

Upload only the anonymized file to a school-approved AI tool.

**4**

### Put names back

Bring the AI's answer back to the tool with your key. Codes turn back into names.

# Before you start

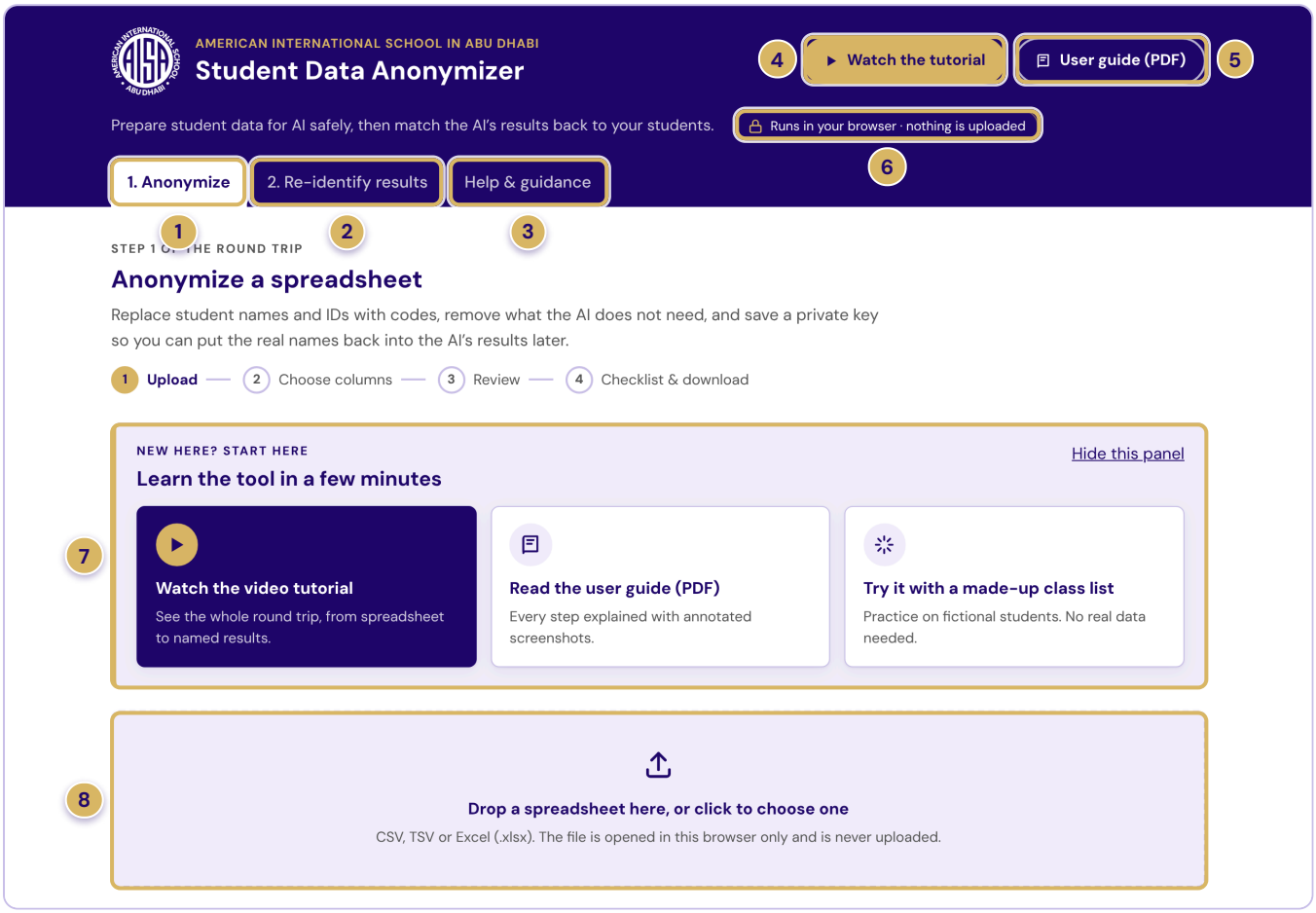
- Go to **aisa-ai-web.github.io/data-anonymizer**. There is no sign-in.
- Use an up-to-date Chrome, Edge or Safari on a school laptop.
- Have your spreadsheet ready as a **CSV** or **Excel (.xlsx)** file, for example an export from your student information system.
- Know which **school-approved AI tool** you'll use. If you're not sure which tools are approved, ask before you start.
- Allow about 10 minutes the first time.
- Prefer to watch first? Click **Watch the tutorial** at the top of the tool for a short walkthrough.

FIVE RULES TO REMEMBER

1. Only the **anonymized file** goes to the AI. Never the original spreadsheet.
2. The **key file** stays private. Never upload it to an AI tool.
3. The tool's suggestions can be wrong. **Your judgment decides** what is shared.
4. Use only a **school-approved AI tool**, never a personal account.
5. A person, not the AI, makes decisions about students. Check results for mistakes and bias.

# A quick tour

This is the first screen you see when you open the tool.




*The first screen. The numbers match the list below.*

1. **1. Anonymize** (tab): turn a spreadsheet into an anonymized file and a key. You start here.
2. **2. Re-identify results** (tab): put the real names back into the AI's answer.
3. **Help & guidance** (tab): the video tutorial, what to do with each kind of data, good practice and policy links.
4. **Watch the tutorial** (top-right): plays a short video walkthrough of the whole process.
5. **User guide (PDF)** (top-right): opens this guide.
6. **Runs in your browser · nothing is uploaded**: a reminder that your files never leave your computer.
7. **Start here** panel: watch the video, open this guide, or **Try it with a made-up class list**. Click **Hide this panel** once you know the tool.
8. **Drop a spreadsheet here, or click to choose one**: where you add your file.

> **Tip:** Try the whole process once with the made-up class list. It takes five minutes and uses no real student data.

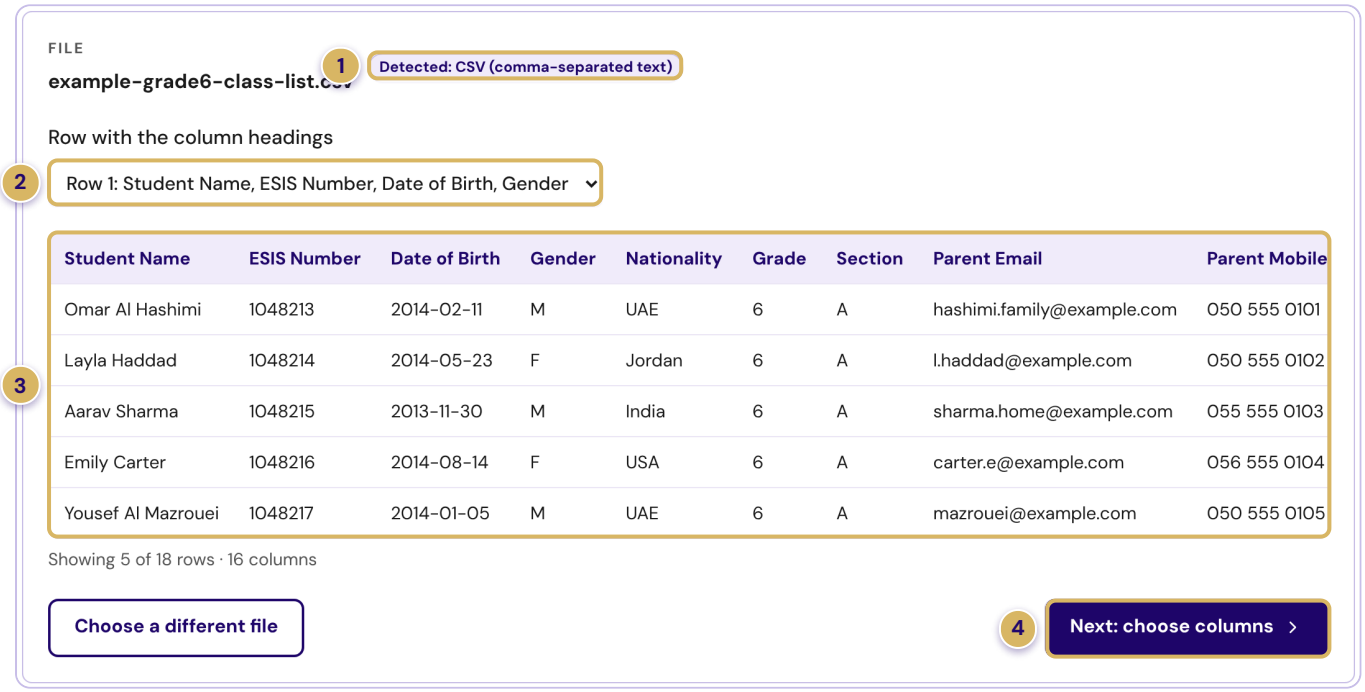
JOB 1

# How to anonymize a spreadsheet

Do this every time you want an AI tool to look at student data. It has five parts: upload, choose columns, review, checklist and download.

## Part A · Upload your file

1. Open the tool at **aisa-ai-web.github.io/data-anonymizer**. The **1. Anonymize** tab is already open.
2. Drag your spreadsheet onto the box that says **Drop a spreadsheet here, or click to choose one**. You can also click the box and choose the file.
3. Check the **Detected** label shows the right file type 1.
4. Check **Row with the column headings** 2. If the preview's top row isn't your headings, choose the right row from the list.
5. Look at the preview 3 to make sure it's the right file.
6. Click **Next: choose columns** 4.



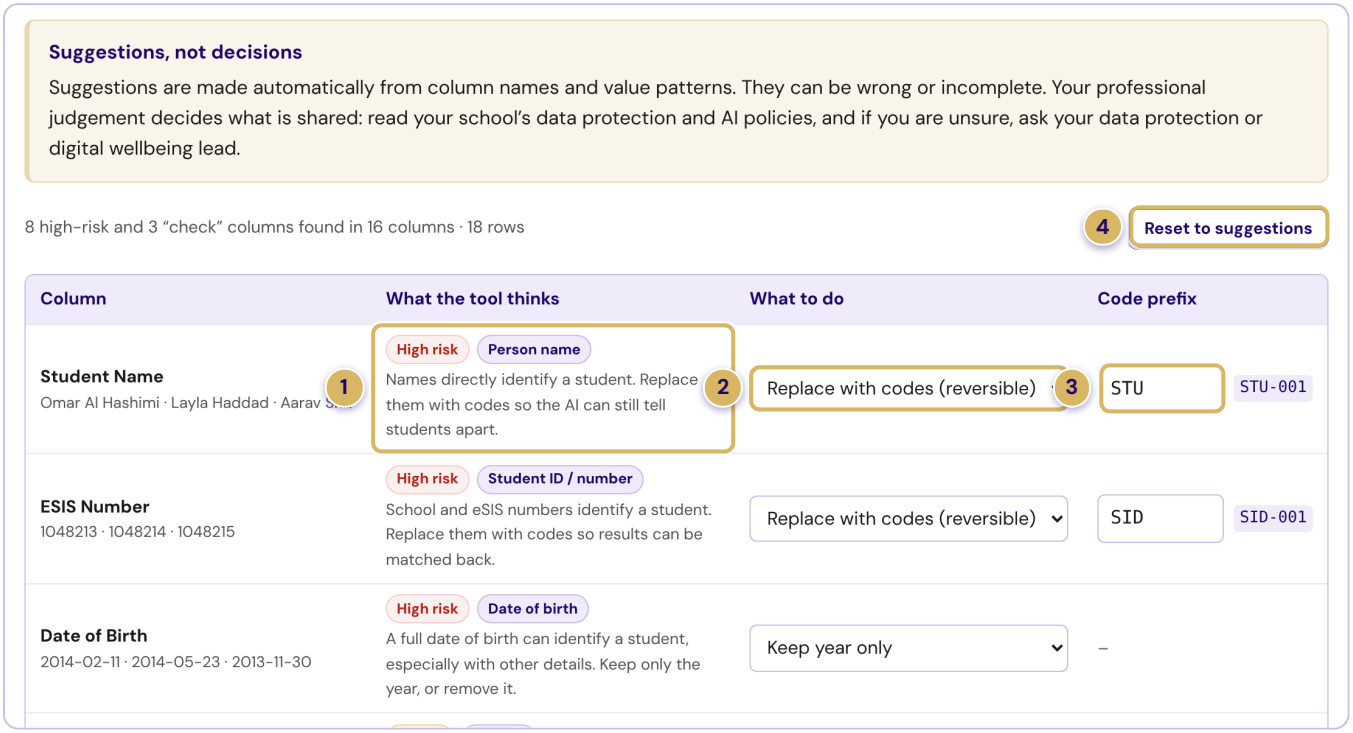

*After upload, the tool shows what it found in your file.*

> **Watch out:** Older Excel files (**.xls**) won't open. In Excel, choose **File › Save As › Excel Workbook (.xlsx)** and upload the new file. If your workbook has several sheets, choose one from the **Sheet** list; only that sheet is used.

## Part B · Choose what happens to each column

The tool reads every column and suggests what to do with it. Suggestions are a starting point, not a decision.

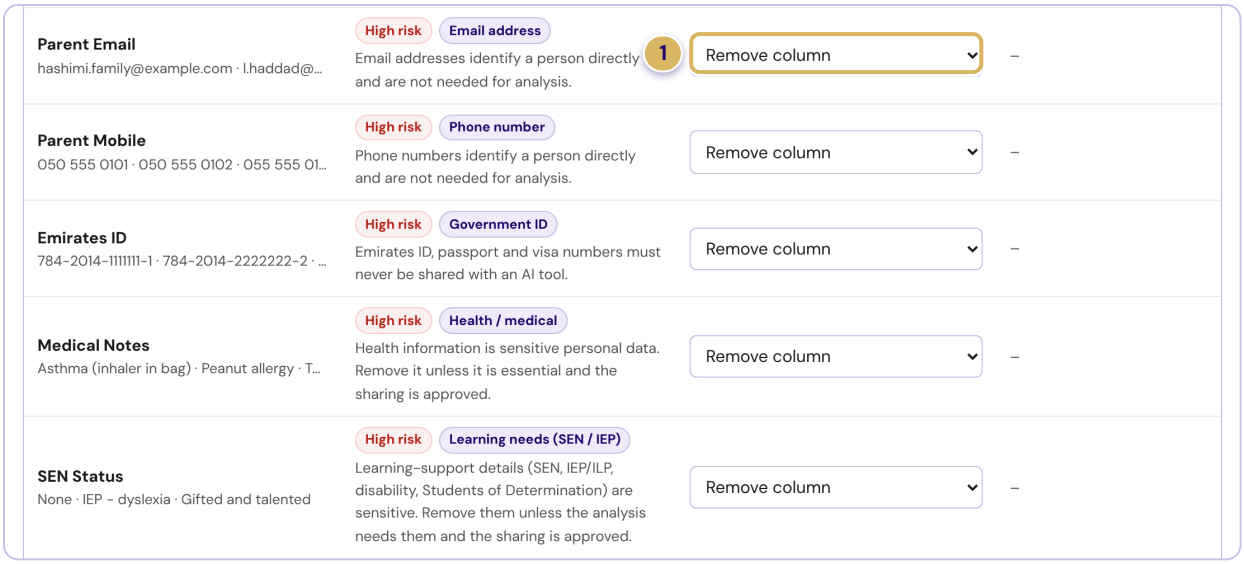
7. Read the **Suggestions, not decisions** notice at the top.
8. For each column, read **What the tool thinks**: a risk level and a reason (1).
9. Check the choice under **What to do** (2). Change it if you need to.
10. For columns set to **Replace with codes (reversible)**, check the **Code prefix** (3). The suggested prefix is usually fine.




*Every column has a risk level, a reason and a suggested choice. **Reset to suggestions** (4) undoes your changes.*

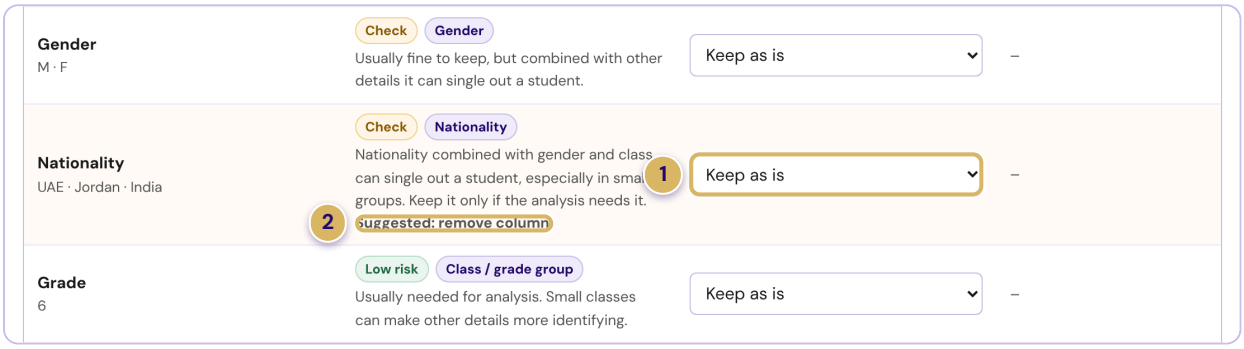
| Choice | What it does | Typical columns |
|---|---|---|
| **Replace with codes (reversible)** | Swaps each value for a code like STU-004. The same student always gets the same code. The key can turn it back. | Student names, student or eSIS numbers |
| **Remove column** | Leaves the column out of the file entirely. | Emails, phone numbers, Emirates ID, addresses, medical, SEN |
| **Keep year only** | Keeps the year and drops the day and month. | Date of birth |
| **Keep as is** | Shares the column unchanged. | Scores, attendance, grade, section |

High risk identifies a student or is sensitive. Check needs your judgment. Low risk is usually fine to share.




*Contact details, Emirates ID, medical and SEN columns are set to **Remove column** 1.*

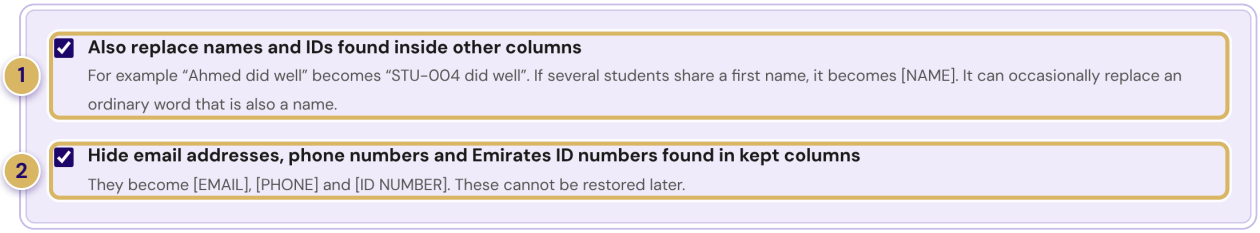
**11.** If you change a suggestion 1, the row turns yellow and shows the original suggestion underneath 2.




*Nationality changed to **Keep as is**. The tool still shows what it suggested.*

> **Watch out:** Only keep a **High risk** column if the analysis really needs it and sharing it is approved. If you're unsure, remove it.

**12.** Below the column list, leave both protection options ticked 1 2.



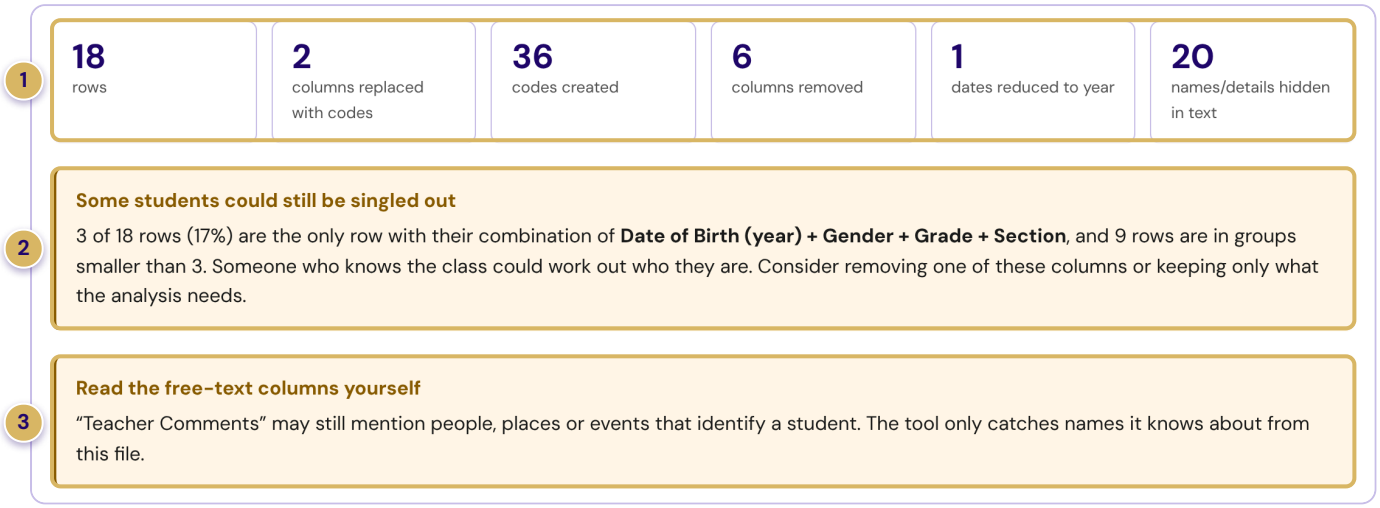

*The first option replaces names inside comments. The second hides emails, phone numbers and Emirates ID numbers.*

**13.** Click **Next: review**.

## Part C · Review the risks

Before anything is shared, the tool shows what it changed and warns you about anything risky that's left.

14. Read the numbers at the top (1): rows, codes created, columns removed and names hidden in text.
15. Read every warning (2) (3) and act on it (see the list below).




*The review summary and warnings.*

- **Some students could still be singled out**: a few rows are the only ones with that mix of details, such as year of birth, gender and class. Click **Back to columns** and remove or reduce one of the columns it names.
- **Read the free-text columns yourself**: comments may mention siblings, places or events the tool can't recognize. Read them before sharing.
- **Contact details or ID numbers are still in the data**: go back and remove that column, or tick the option to hide them.
- **You are keeping high-risk columns**: keep them only if the analysis needs them and sharing is approved.

16. Scroll to **Preview of what will be shared** and check it. Shared first names show as **[NAME]** (1); known names become codes (2).

| Date of Birth (year) | Gender | Grade | Section | Reading Level | Math Score (%) | Attendance (%) | Teacher Comments |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2014 | M | 6 | A | On track | 78 | 96 | 1 [NAME] is confident in class discuss… |
| 2014 | F | 6 | A | Above | 91 | 98 | 2 STU-006 is reading well above grad… |
| 2013 | M | 6 | A | On track | 85 | 94 | STU-003 helped STU-012 with frac… |
| 2014 | F | 6 | A | Below | 62 | 91 | STU-012 benefits from audio texts … |
| 2014 | M | 6 | A | On track | 74 | 88 | STU-016 has been late several time… |
| 2014 | F | 6 | A | Above | 88 | 99 | STU-002 leads her group well. |
| 2014 | M | 6 | B | On track | 69 | 93 | STU-018 needs support with multi-… |
| 2013 | F | 6 | B | On track | 81 | 97 | STU-015 is organised and consistent. |
| 2014 | M | 6 | B | Above | 97 | 95 | STU-005 is ready for extension tasks. |
| 2014 | F | 6 | B | Below | 58 | 86 | STU-017 finds fractions difficult; sm… |

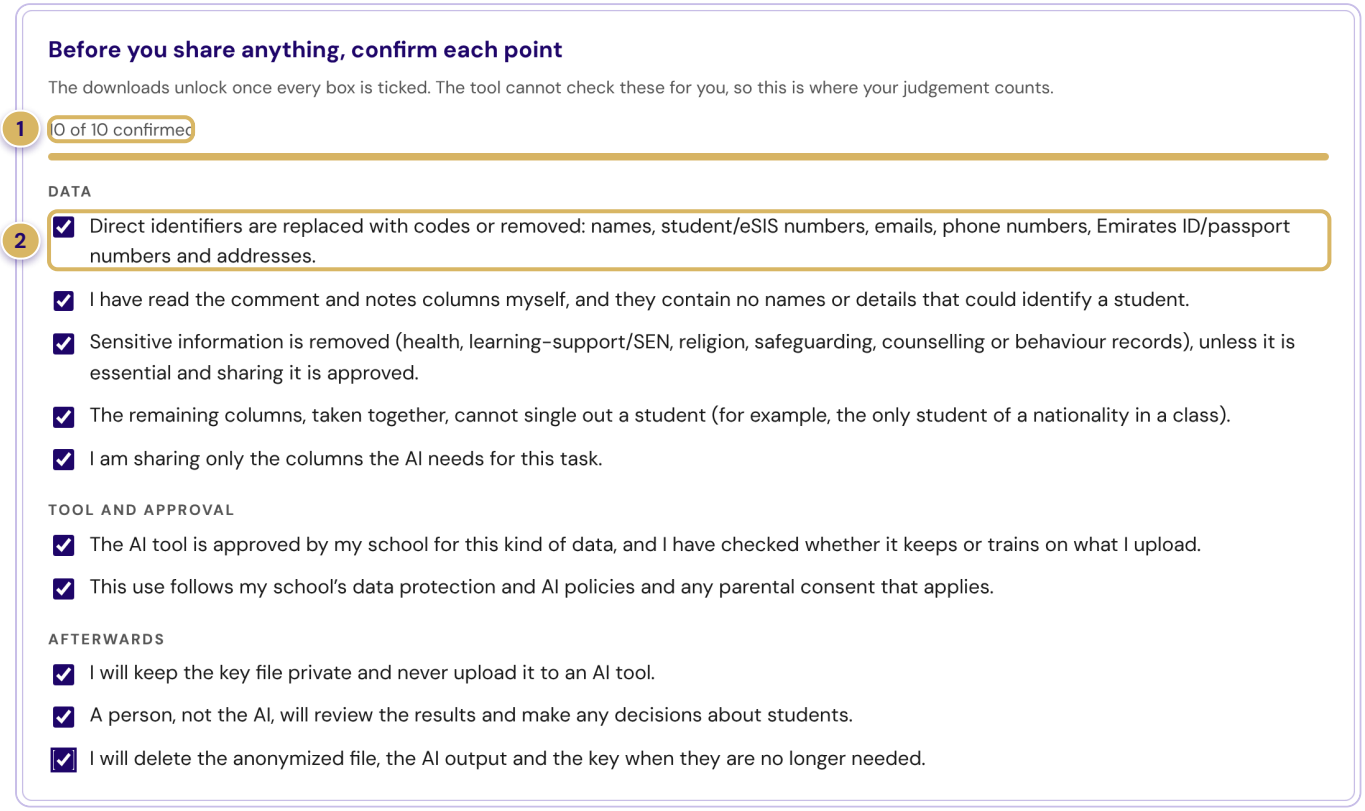
*The comments column after anonymizing. Scroll sideways in the preview to see every column.*

17. If you need to change something, click **Back to columns**. Otherwise click **Next: checklist**.

## Part D · Confirm the checklist

The downloads stay locked until you've confirmed each point. The tool can't check these for you; this is where your judgment counts.

18. Read each point and tick its box only when it's true (2). The counter shows your progress (1).



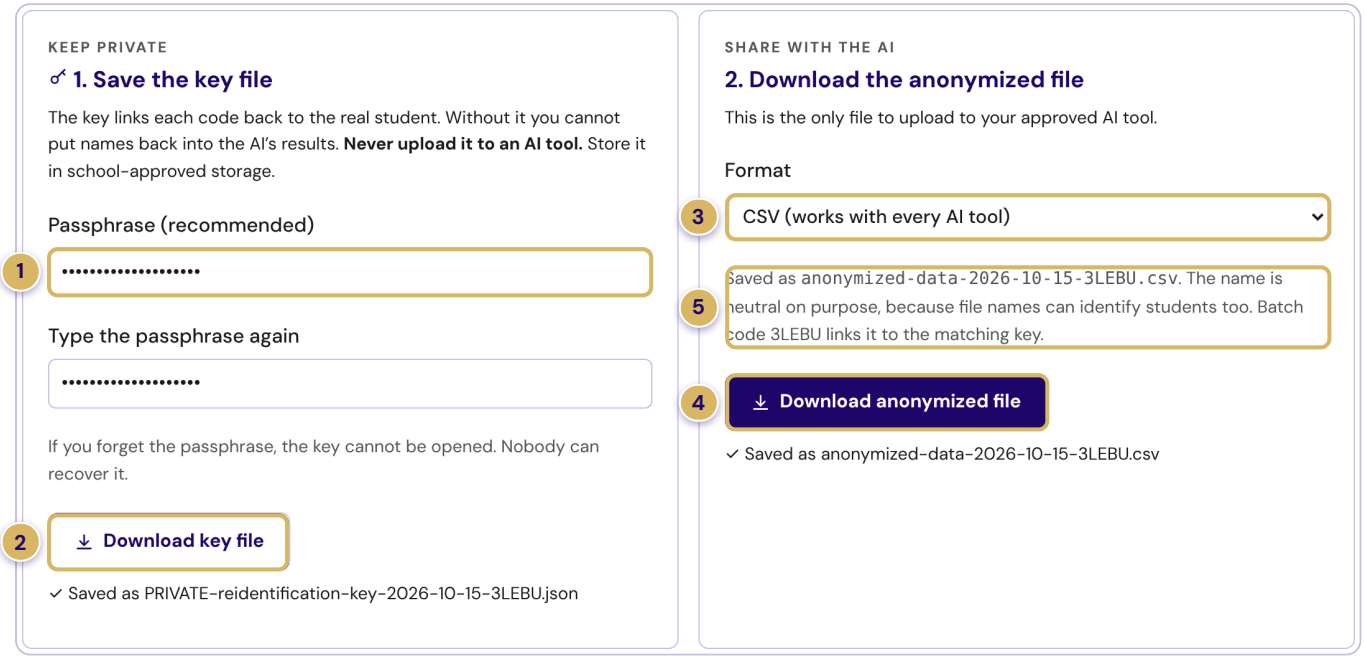

*Ten points in three groups: **Data**, **Tool and approval** and **Afterwards**.*

> **Watch out:** If a point isn't true, don't tick it. Go back and fix the data, or ask your data protection or digital wellbeing lead before sharing anything.

## Part E · Save the key and the anonymized file

You download two files: the **key file**, which you keep private, and the **anonymized file**, which goes to the AI.

19. Type a passphrase in **Passphrase (recommended)** 1, then type it again in the box below.
20. Click **Download key file** 2. Move it to school-approved storage, such as your school drive.
21. Choose a **Format** 3. **CSV** works with every AI tool.
22. Click **Download anonymized file** 4. This is the only file you upload to the AI.




*Left: the private key. Right: the file for the AI. Both file names end with the same batch code* 5.

> **Watch out:** The key file is the only way to put the names back, and it lists every student. Never upload it to an AI tool. If you forget the passphrase, nobody can open the key, so keep it somewhere safe.

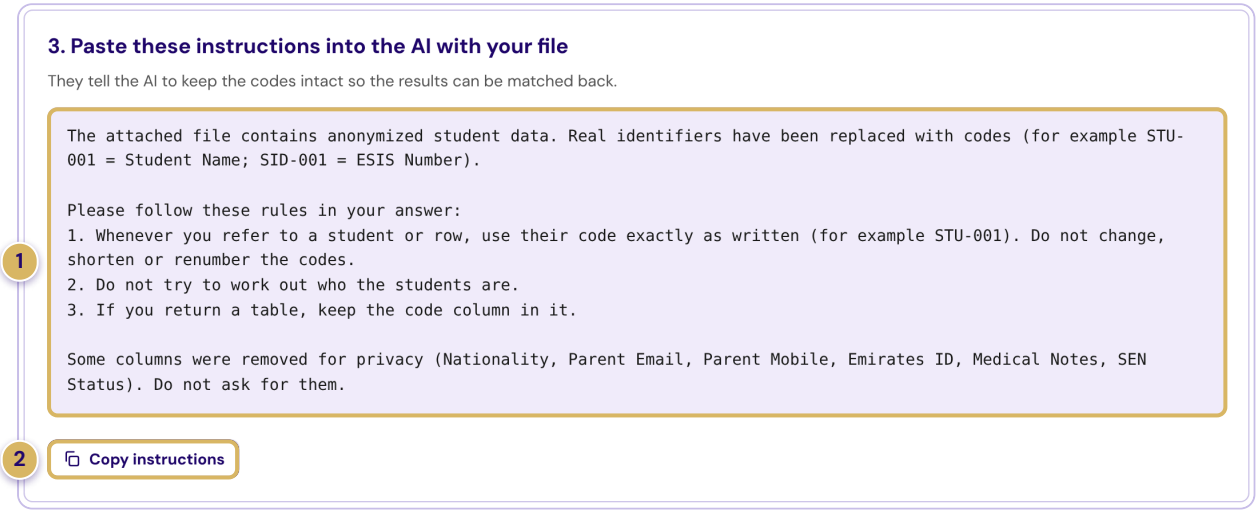
> **Tip:** The downloaded file names are neutral on purpose, because original file names often include a student's or class's name. Use the batch code to match a key to its file.

JOB 2

# How to use the anonymized file with an AI tool

Do this after you've downloaded the anonymized file. The AI only ever sees codes.

1. Under **Paste these instructions into the AI with your file** 1, click **Copy instructions** 2.
2. Open your school-approved AI tool.
3. Upload the anonymized file (its name starts with **anonymized-data**).
4. Paste the instructions into the chat.
5. Type your question. Ask for a table that keeps the code column.
6. Download or copy the AI's answer when it's ready.

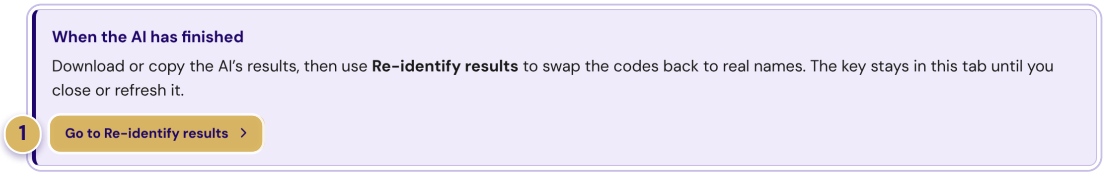



*The instructions ask the AI to keep every code exactly as written, so its answer can be matched back.*

EXAMPLE QUESTIONS

- "Group these students for a fractions intervention based on Math Score. Return a table with Student Name, Group and Reason."
- "Which students have attendance below 90% and a Reading Level of Below? Return their codes with both values."
- "Summarize the patterns in Teacher Comments and list the codes of students who may need extension work."

**Watch out:** Never upload the key file or your original spreadsheet. Don't use a personal AI account for student data.




*When you return, click Go to Re-identify results 1. The key stays loaded until you close or refresh the tab.*

JOB 3

# How to put the names back into the AI's results

Do this when the AI has answered. If you're still in the same browser tab, the key is already loaded.

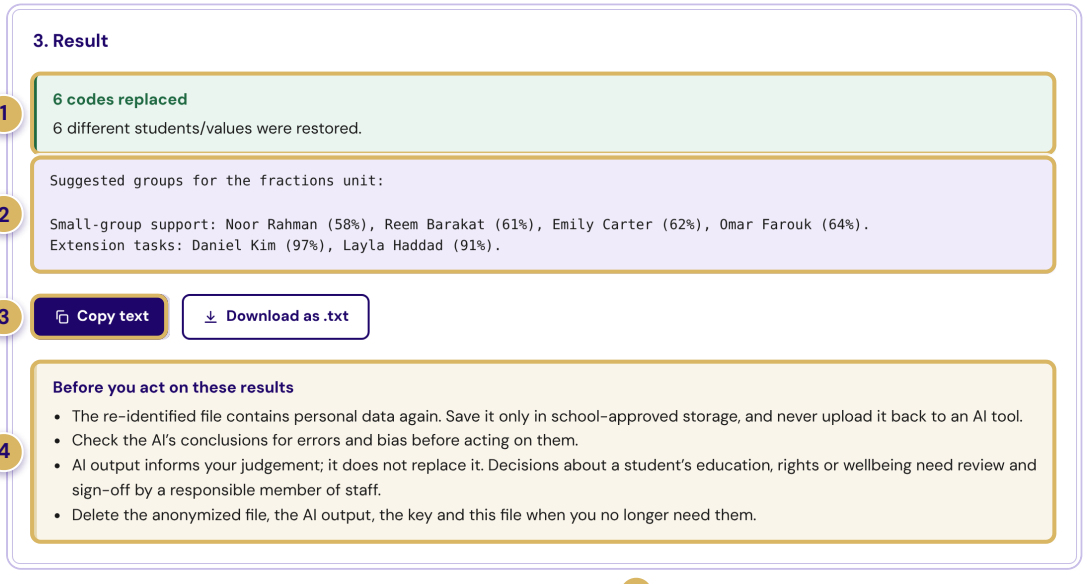
## If you're still in the same tab

1. Click the **2. Re-identify results** tab. You'll see **Key loaded** 1.
2. Click **Paste text** 2.
3. Paste the AI's answer into the box 3.
4. Click **Put the names back** 4.




*The key is loaded and the AI's answer, which only contains codes, is pasted in.*

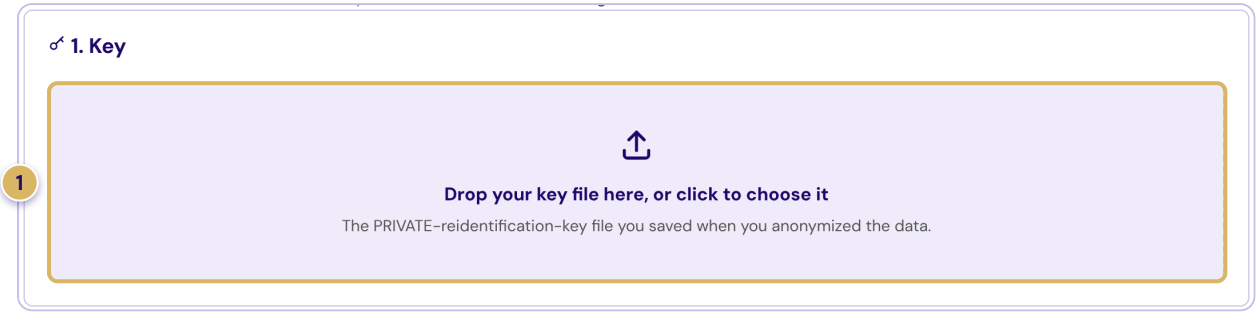
5. Check the green message 1, then read the answer with the real names 2.
6. Click **Copy text** 3 or **Download as .txt**.




*The same answer with names restored. Read the reminders 4 before you act on it.*

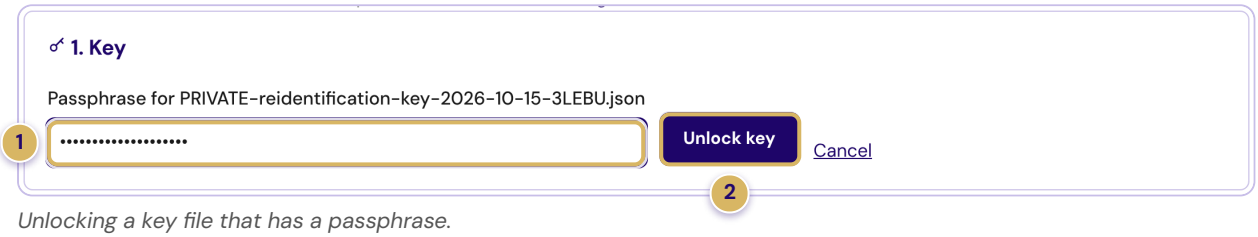
## If you closed the tab, or come back another day

1. Open the tool and click the **2. Re-identify results** tab.
2. Drag your key file onto **Drop your key file here, or click to choose it** 1.



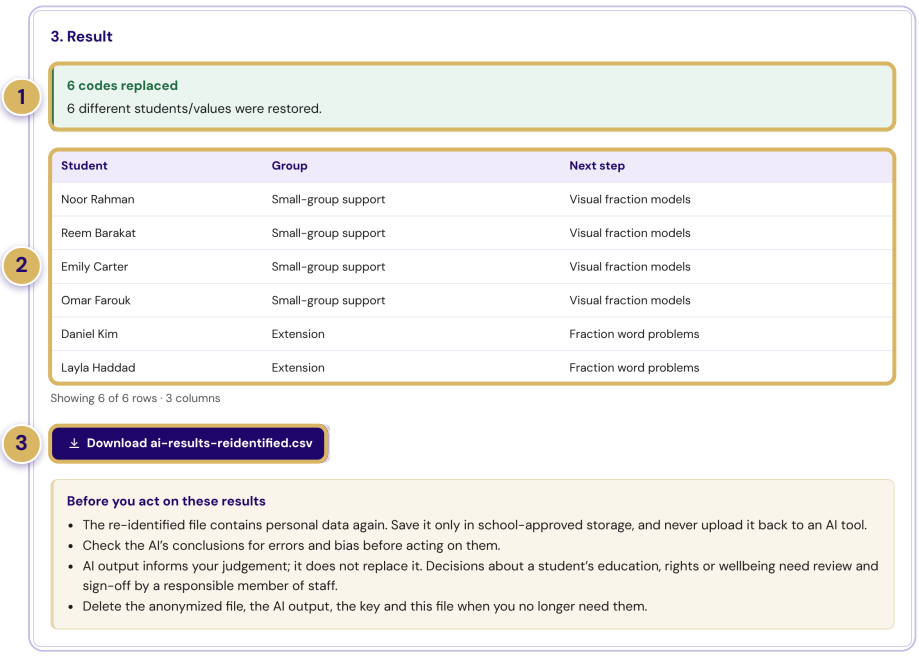

*Load the key file you saved in Part E.*

3. If you set a passphrase, type it 1 and click **Unlock key** 2.




*Unlocking a key file that has a passphrase.*

4. Drag the AI's file onto **Drop the AI's output file here**. CSV, Excel, .txt, .md, .json and .html all work.
5. Check the green message 1 and the preview 2, then click **Download** 3.




*An AI results table with the names restored, ready to download.*

JOB 4

# When you've finished

The re-identified results contain personal data again, so treat them like the original spreadsheet.

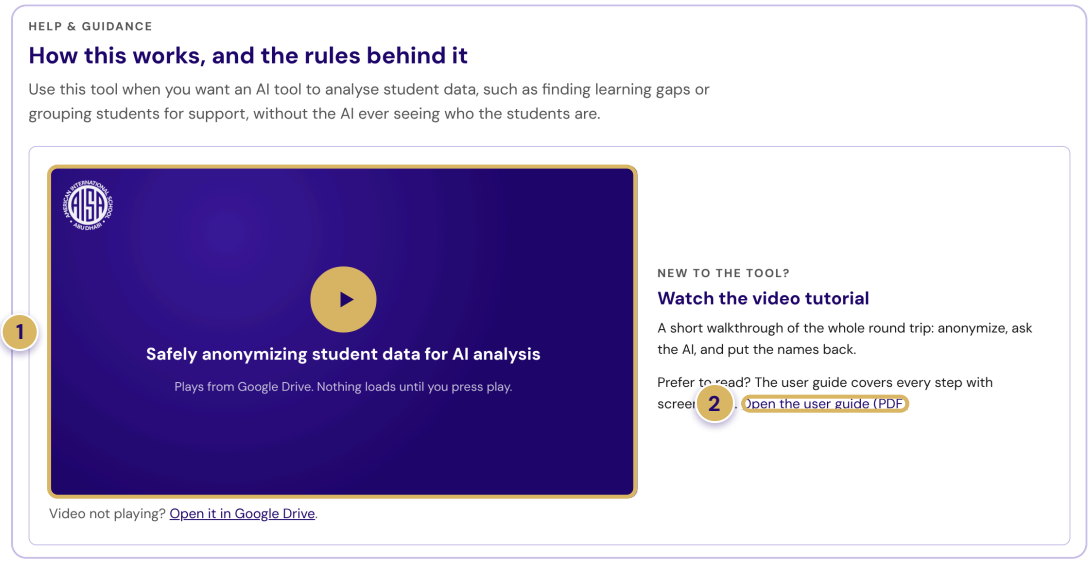
1. Check the AI's conclusions for mistakes and bias, for example patterns that unfairly single out a gender or nationality.
2. Make decisions yourself. Decisions about a student's education, rights or wellbeing need review and sign-off by a responsible member of staff.
3. Save named results only in school-approved storage. Never upload them back into an AI tool.
4. Delete the anonymized file, the AI's output, the key file and the re-identified file when you no longer need them.

## What the result messages mean

| Message | What it means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| **… codes replaced** (green) | Codes were found and turned back into names. | Check the result and carry on. |
| **Some codes are not in the key** | The AI changed or invented a code, or it comes from a different batch. | Treat anything linked to those codes with caution. |
| **No codes were found** | The key doesn't match this data, or the AI dropped the codes. | Check the batch codes match, and that the AI's answer contains codes. |

## Learn more in the tool

The **Help & guidance** tab explains what to do with each kind of data and links to the ADEK School Digital Policy and the UAE data protection law. It also has the video tutorial 1 and a link to this guide 2.




*The top of the Help & guidance tab. The video only loads from Google Drive when you press play.*

# Troubleshooting

**My file won't open.**

Older **.xls** files must be saved as **.xlsx** first. Apple Numbers and OpenDocument files need to be exported as .xlsx or .csv.

**The column headings are wrong in the preview.**

Your file probably has a title above the table. Choose the right row in **Row with the column headings**.

**The tool suggested the wrong thing for a column.**

Change it under **What to do**. Suggestions come from column names and patterns, so they can be wrong. Tell the AI & Innovation team so the tool can improve.

**A comment still mentions a student.**

The tool only replaces names that appear in a column you replaced with codes. Go back, fix the text in your original file, and upload it again.

**I closed the tab before putting the names back.**

Open the tool, click **2. Re-identify results** and load the key file you saved.

**I forgot the passphrase.**

The key can't be opened. Anonymize the original spreadsheet again to get a new key and file, then repeat the AI step.

**No codes were found in the AI's answer.**

Check the batch code on the key matches the anonymized file, and ask the AI to keep the codes exactly as written.

**Arabic names look garbled after download.**

Open the CSV with Excel's **Data › From Text/CSV** and choose **UTF-8**, or download the Excel (.xlsx) format instead.

NEED HELP?

Contact the **AI & Innovation team**. For questions about whether data can be shared, ask your data protection or digital wellbeing lead.

For a walkthrough, click **Watch the tutorial** at the top of the tool.

QUICK REFERENCE

1. Upload › check headings › **Next: choose columns**
2. Check every column › **Next: review**
3. Act on warnings › **Next: checklist**
4. Tick the checklist › save the key › download the file
5. Approved AI tool › upload file › paste instructions
6. **2. Re-identify results** › paste or upload › put names back